

Gampaha District, reported as the most populous district, shows the highest number of households, followed by Colombo District, which has the second-highest number of households. The lowest number of households is reported from Mannar district, while the second lowest number of households is reported from Mullaitivu district.

Further Mullaitivu (12.4%) shows the highest percentage of one person households. Trincomalee (68.1%) shows the highest percentage of nuclear households, and Kegalle (34.1%) reports the highest percentage of extended households. The highest percentage of composite households (2.8%) is reported from Colombo district.

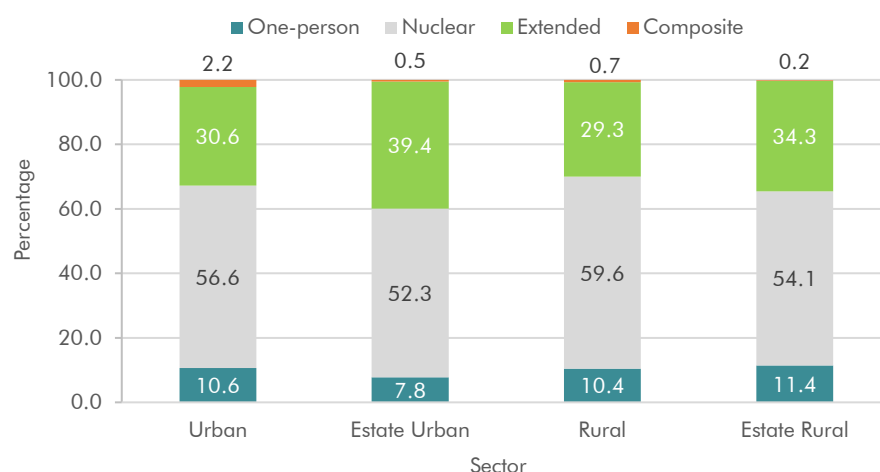


Figure 10.1 : Percentage Distribution of the Number of Households by Sector and Household Type, 2024

10.6 Characteristics of the Head of Household

The total number of households in Sri Lanka is 6,111,315, with a corresponding number of household heads. The distribution of household heads by his/her ethnic group and type of household is shown in Table 10.3. The highest number of household heads are reported from nuclear households, and no significant variation is observed in this pattern among the major ethnic groups. However, among household heads belonging to other ethnic groups, a relatively higher percentage of households are reported as one-person households.

Table 10.3 : Percentage Distribution of the Number of Household Heads by Ethnic group of the Head of Household and type of Household, 2024

Ethnic group of the Head of Household	Total number of Household Heads	Household Type			
		One Person	Nuclear	Extended	Composite
Sri Lanka	6,111,315	640,704	3,598,976	1,815,522	56,113
	100.0	10.5	58.9	29.7	0.9
Sinhala	4,629,912	502,826	2,706,132	1,373,944	47,010
	100.0	10.9	58.4	29.7	1.0
Sri Lanka Tamil	740,275	79,257	443,391	212,290	5,337
	100.0	10.7	59.9	28.7	0.7
Indian Tamil/Malaiyaga Thamilar	163,147	16,975	88,030	57,446	696
	100.0	10.4	54.0	35.2	0.4
Sri Lanka Moor/Muslim	557,128	39,047	350,428	165,128	2,525
	100.0	7.0	62.9	29.6	0.5
Other	20,853	2,599	10,995	6,714	545
	100.0	12.5	52.7	32.2	2.6